

Pain relief options

A PRIOR KNOWLEDGE OF PAIN RELIEF WILL HELP YOU MAKE INFORMED CHOICES IN LABOR.

Once in labor, in addition to needing emotional and physical support, which your doctor, nurse, or midwife and birth partner will provide, you may also need some form of pain relief to help you cope. They will help you work with your labor pain by employing natural methods such as breathing techniques. If you need stronger pain relief, they'll advise you on medical methods, such as analgesics or an epidural (see [Drugs for pain relief](#)).